

the environmental crisis of AI

Posted by u/Hot-Principle8109 • • 0 points • 8 comments

There's a growing discourse around the significant energy demands of ai, particularly in light of its environmental impact. Is anyone else very concerned about this? Do you think we'll develop more energy-efficient systems and adapt, or is this a deeper systemic issue? Are you troubled by the increasing diversion of water and power resources that AI uses? Is this the beginning of the end for our energy crisis or environmental crisis? What are people trying to do about this issue right now?

Comments

u/Enough_Island4615 • 1 points • 2025-06-30 03:46 UTC

And the energy crisis of TikTok, Reddit, Gaming, alcohol production and consumption, unnecessary flying and driving, and on and on. No matter for what, human energy consumption will continue to increase exponentially. It is unstoppable and, as such, the only problem to solve is how that energy is produced.

u/Marcus-Musashi • 1 points • 2025-06-30 03:07 UTC

The whole planet might become one big datacenter filled with solar panels...

u/Mathandyr • 1 points • 2025-06-30 02:50 UTC

Necessity is the mother of all invention, and energy has been artificially stifled for decades by big oil. Ever heard someone argue that solar can't produce power when it's cloudy, or that it's more damaging to produce than the energy it provides? Those are 10-20 year old talking points that aren't true anymore.

Notice how conservatives in the US were adamantly against electric vehicles until they started cheering for musk?

With all of that information, the dots become pretty easy to connect.

It is in corporations best interest, especially for their pocket books, to address the energy problem, and I 99% guarantee you they "magically" will.

Take a look at what China is doing with solar. I kind of hate their execution but it's absolutely lighting the (beneficial) fire for everyone else.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-06-30 02:50 UTC

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u/lamnotheattack • 4 points • 2025-06-30 02:41 UTC

Here is a good overview regarding energy

<https://www.iea.org/reports/energy-and-ai/executive-summary>

Similar, but with a pretty critical lens: <https://docs.google.com/document/d/14KSdT5yig-rfzS5icloVreWBrqNapS4-GMkvMOwHzUY/edit?usp=sharing>

u/HarmadeusZex • -3 points • 2025-06-30 02:28 UTC

And again, repetitive and dumb question. Everything demands energy. If no go live in a forest

u/scuttledclaw • 1 points • 2025-06-30 02:58 UTC

The power demand from the data centers these things run on is high enough that Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon are all investing heavily in developing/redeveloping nuclear power plants to cover the demand. As I understood it, it's basically like another France (pop. 70 mil) worth of power consumption has been added in the last couple of years by the AI industry, and they're just getting started.

Are you sure you really thought through your response?

u/Enough_Island4615 • 2 points • 2025-06-30 03:49 UTC

You've highlighted that perhaps this is a good development, spurring the transition to a nuclear energy renaissance.

u/lamnotheattack • 5 points • 2025-06-30 02:35 UTC

False dichotomy.